DC Site Intelligence

NexPhase Advisory

Across all 50 US data-center markets, **Arizona** leads NexPhase's Site Intelligence ranking at **9.6/10** on grid infrastructure depth and quality, followed by **Texas** and **Nevada**.

RANKED MARKETS: TOP 10 OF 50

The score ranks grid strength and load growth from measured data only: interconnection-queue infrastructure density and depth, and EIA-861 retail sales growth. Market Tier, Permitting and BTM are shown for context and are not scored.*

#	State	Score	Market Tier*	Depth S·M·L	EIA-861 retail sales, avg annual growth 2022-2024 (historical)
1	**AZ**	**9.6**	Competitive	16·42	+3.6%
2	**TX**	**9.3**	Competitive	11·159	+3.4%
3	**NV**	**8.9**	Emerging	15·21	+1.6%
4	**OR**	**8.6**	Competitive	4·29	+3.6%
5	**GA**	**8.3**	Competitive	5·21	+1.4%
6	**CA**	**8.1**	Competitive	23·54	+0.0%
7	**OH**	**8.1**	Competitive	3·21	+5.8%
8	**UT**	**7.9**	Underdeveloped	4·10	+1.9%
9	**FL**	**7.8**	Underdeveloped	4·20	+1.3%
10	**OK**	**7.8**	Underdeveloped	6·31	+2.1%

** Market Tier is a NexPhase assessment shown for context; it is not scored.*

EIA-861 retail sales data covers all 50 states. Where EIA has no data for a state, the column shows n/a and that factor is left out of the state's score, with the remaining weights rescaled to 100%. Missing data is not scored as a negative. (Changed October 14, 2026: earlier versions scored missing data as the lowest growth.)

Coverage tone (news headlines, latest daily read, 2026-10-14, 50 states): 0 positive, 1 neutral, 24 moderately negative, 25 strongly negative. The read does not yet separate states, so no per-state label is shown.

TOP 3 MARKETS

Arizona #1 · 9.6/10

Arizona ranks #1 at 9.6/10, carried by 16 STRONG and 42 MODERATE density substations (avg 5.05/10 across 224 queue substations). As a Competitive market (NexPhase assessment), EIA-861 retail sales grew an average of 3.6% a year over 2022-2024 (historical).

Texas #2 · 9.3/10

Texas ranks #2 at 9.3/10, carried by 11 STRONG and 159 MODERATE density substations (avg 4.28/10 across 1716 queue substations). As a Competitive market (NexPhase assessment), EIA-861 retail sales grew an average of 3.4% a year over 2022-2024 (historical).

Nevada #3 · 8.9/10

Nevada ranks #3 at 8.9/10, carried by 15 STRONG and 21 MODERATE density substations (avg 4.82/10 across 143 queue substations). As an Emerging market (NexPhase assessment), EIA-861 retail sales grew an average of 1.6% a year over 2022-2024 (historical).

ROOM TO GROW

The five highest-scoring states that are not Competitive markets (Market Tier is a NexPhase assessment, shown for context).

Nevada #3 · 8.9/10 · Emerging. Infrastructure density 2nd of 50, grid depth 4th; EIA-861 retail sales up 1.6% a year (2022-2024).

Utah #8 · 7.9/10 · Underdeveloped, established data-center market. Infrastructure density 7th of 50, grid depth 17th; EIA-861 retail sales up 1.9% a year (2022-2024).

Florida #9 · 7.8/10 · Underdeveloped, established data-center market. Infrastructure density 9th of 50, grid depth 13th; EIA-861 retail sales up 1.3% a year (2022-2024).

Oklahoma #10 · 7.8/10 · Underdeveloped, established data-center market. Infrastructure density 19th of 50, grid depth 5th; EIA-861 retail sales up 2.1% a year (2022-2024).

Wyoming #12 · 7.6/10 · Underdeveloped, established data-center market. Infrastructure density 6th of 50, grid depth 29th; EIA-861 retail sales up 3.0% a year (2022-2024).

METHODOLOGY

This index scores each state on measured data only (below), not on current market size or existing inventory.

What this index measures. This report is a *Generation Infrastructure Density Index*. It measures where transmission and interconnection infrastructure exists based on active interconnection-queue activity: the concentration of utility-scale generation projects queuing to inject power at each substation. A high density score means many generation projects are queued at that substation.

What it does not measure. This index does not measure *load-serving capacity*, the ability of a utility to serve a new large power consumer at a specific location. A high-scoring state has strong transmission infrastructure but may still require a utility service availability study to confirm spare transformer capacity and large-load interconnection timelines.

How to use this report. Use this index to pre-screen markets before utility outreach. High-scoring markets warrant further diligence. Low-scoring markets have less queued generation at their substations; confirm

large-load service timelines with the utility. This report does not replace a utility service availability confirmation.

How the index is scored. Each market is scored 1-10 from measured data only, weighted: Infrastructure density 42%, STRONG + MODERATE grid depth 29%, EIA-861 retail sales, avg annual growth 2022-2024 (historical) 29%. Market Tier, Permitting and BTM are NexPhase assessments shown for context; they are not scored.

Scaling. Continuous factors (infrastructure density, grid depth, load growth) are scaled by percentile rank: a state's position among the 50 states, from 0 (lowest) to 1 (highest), with tied states sharing the lower position; no manual caps.

Changed October 14, 2026: factors now scaled by percentile rank, which raises most scores relative to earlier versions.

Changed October 14, 2026: Market Tier is no longer scored. The score now uses measured data only (infrastructure density 42%, grid depth 29%, load growth 29%); Market Tier, Permitting and BTM are shown for context. Built-out markets are no longer marked down for having less room to grow.

*** Market tiers.** Market tiers are a NexPhase assessment shown for context; they are not scored. Competitive: the states with the largest existing data-center build-out (AZ, CA, GA, IL, OH, OR, TX, VA). Emerging: states where data-center development is growing but not yet concentrated (IA, IN, LA, MS, NC, NV, PA, TN, WI). Underdeveloped: every other state; of those, AL, CO, CT, FL, MA, MD, MI, NE, NJ, NY, OK, SC, UT, WA, WY have an established data-center market and the other 18 do not yet. Reviewed by NexPhase; changes are dated in the method note. Changed October 14, 2026: Ohio to Competitive; Pennsylvania, Indiana, Iowa, Tennessee, Mississippi, Louisiana and Wisconsin to Emerging; Nebraska, Oklahoma, Wyoming, South Carolina and Alabama recognized as established data-center markets, on current data-center build-out.

Community sentiment. A daily read of news coverage of data-center development; it is currently one-sided (almost every state reads negative), so only the Coverage tone counts under the table are shown and it does not affect the score.

Behind-the-meter (BTM) policy. BTM generation rules vary by utility within each state. Consult utility tariff schedules before assuming BTM viability. This field reflects general state-level regulatory posture only.

Chris Santiago · NexPhase Advisory
Two decades in utility-scale development · 5+ GW taken to NTP across major U.S. ISOs and RTOs
DC Site Intelligence is part of the NexPhase Intelligence Platform, alongside The Interconnect and The Morning Read: intel.nexphaseadvisory.net/platform/

Data sources: Interconnection queue data: live as of 2026-10-14, sourced from ISO/RTO public queues (PJM, MISO, ERCOT, SPP, CAISO, NYISO, ISO-NE) and West / Southeast utility OASIS queue files | EIA substation data: 2023 vintage (EIA-860) | Utility load data: EIA-861 retail sales, 2022-2024 (historical) | Community sentiment: a daily read from news coverage.
Compiled from publicly available sources: ISO/RTO and utility interconnection queue data and the EIA-860 & EIA-861 surveys. Analysis reflects Chris Santiago's independent professional assessment. Scores refresh weekly.

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